



GSFA Online

Updated up to the 48th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (2025)

FOOD ADDITIVE DETAILS

Methyl cellulose (461)

Synonym(s)

- Cellulose Methyl Ether
- Methyl Ether of Cellulose

Functional Classes

- Bulking agent
- Emulsifier
- Glazing agent
- Stabilizer
- Thickener

 [Click here to search the FAO JECFA database for the specifications of additive\(s\) with INS No. 461](#)

 [Click here to search the WHO JECFA database for evaluation of additive\(s\) with INS No. 461](#)

CSV (Tables)

GSFA Provisions for Methyl cellulose

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 14.1.5	Coffee, coffee substitutes, tea, herbal infusions, and other hot cereal and grain beverages, excluding cocoa		GMP  Note 160
 09.2.4.1	Cooked fish and fish products		GMP  Note 325  Note 16
 09.2.4.2	Cooked mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms		GMP  Note 16
 01.2.1.2	Fermented milks (plain), heat-treated after fermentation		GMP  Note 234
 01.2.1.1	Fermented milks (plain), not heat-treated after fermentation		GMP  Note 235  Note 634  Note 234
 08.1.2	Fresh meat, poultry, and game, comminuted		GMP  Note 281
 08.1.1	Fresh meat, poultry, and game, whole pieces or cuts		GMP  Note 16  Note 326
 09.2.4.3	Fried fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms		GMP  Note 332  Note 325  Note 41
 09.2.2	Frozen battered fish, fish fillets, and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms		GMP  Note 332  Note 177
 09.2.1	Frozen fish, fish fillets, and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms		GMP  Note XS292  Note XS36  Note XS312  Note XS190  Note 391  Note XS95  Note XS92  Note 332  Note XS315  Note XS191
 09.2.3	Frozen minced and creamed fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms		GMP  Note 16

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 11.4	Other sugars and syrups (e.g. xylose, maple syrup, sugar toppings)		GMP  Note 258
 01.4.1	Pasteurized cream (plain)		GMP  Note XS288
 01.2.2	Renneted milk (plain)		GMP
 12.1.2	Salt Substitutes		GMP
 09.2.5	Smoked, dried, fermented, and/or salted fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms		GMP  Note XS222  Note XS236  Note XS311  Note XS167  Note 300  Note XS244  Note 332  Note XS189
 01.4.2	Sterilized and UHT creams, whipping and whipped creams, and reduced fat creams (plain)		GMP

Note: Unless otherwise specified, food additive provisions apply to the food category indicated (e.g. Dairy), as well as to all subcategories of that category (e.g. Cheese, Ripened Cheese, etc.).

GSFA Table 3 Provisions

Methyl cellulose is a food additive that is included in **Table 3**, and as such may be used in the following foods under the conditions of good manufacturing practices (GMP) as outlined in the Preamble of the Codex GSFA. Although not listed below, Methyl cellulose could also be used in heat-treated butter milk of food category 01.1.1 and spices of food category 12.2.1. Note that food categories listed in the **Annex to Table 3** were excluded accordingly. **Methyl cellulose** is acceptable in foods conforming to the following commodity standards: CS 253-2006 (see functional class table and footnote).

Methyl cellulose is a: Emulsifier, Stabilizer, Thickener

Any Emulsifier listed in Table 3 can be acceptable for use in all products conforming to CS 117-1981, CS 309R-2011, CS 256-2007.

Any Stabilizer listed in Table 3 can be acceptable for use in all products conforming to CS 117-1981, CS 256-2007.

Any Thickener listed in Table 3 can be acceptable for use in all products conforming to CS 117-1981, CS 256-2007, CS 306-2011.

Number	Food Category
 01.1.4	Flavoured fluid milk drinks
 01.3	Condensed milk and analogues (plain)
 01.4.3	Clotted cream (plain)
 01.4.4	Cream analogues
 01.5	Milk powder and cream powder and powder analogues (plain)
 01.6.1	Unripened cheese
 01.6.2	Ripened cheese
 01.6.4	Processed cheese
 01.6.5	Cheese analogues
 01.7	Dairy-based desserts (e.g. pudding, fruit or flavoured yoghurt)
 01.8.1	Liquid whey and whey products, excluding whey cheeses
 02.2.2	Fat spreads, dairy fat spreads and blended spreads
 02.3	Fat emulsions mainly of type oil-in-water, including mixed and/or flavoured products based on fat emulsions
 02.4	Fat-based desserts excluding dairy-based dessert products of food category 01.7
 03.0	Edible ices, including sherbet and sorbet
 04.1.2	Processed fruit
 04.2.2.2	Dried vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweeds, and nuts and seeds
 04.2.2.3	Vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), and seaweeds in vinegar, oil, brine, or soybean sauce
 04.2.2.4	Canned or bottled (pasteurized) or retort pouch vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), and seaweeds
 04.2.2.5	Vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweed, and nut and seed purees and spreads (e.g., peanut butter)

Number ▼	Food Category ▼
 04.2.2.6	Vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweed, and nut and seed pulps and preparations (e.g. vegetable desserts and sauces, candied vegetables) other than food category 04.2.2.5
 04.2.2.8	Cooked or fried vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), and seaweeds
 05.0	Confectionery
 06.3	Breakfast cereals, including rolled oats
 06.4.3	Pre-cooked pastas and noodles and like products
 06.5	Cereal and starch based desserts (e.g. rice pudding, tapioca pudding)
 06.6	Batters (e.g. for breading or batters for fish or poultry)
 06.7	Pre-cooked or processed rice products, including rice cakes (Oriental type only)
 06.8	Soybean products (excluding soybean-based seasonings and condiments of food category 12.9)
 07.0	Bakery wares
 08.2	Processed meat, poultry, and game products in whole pieces or cuts
 08.3	Processed comminuted meat, poultry, and game products
 08.4	Edible casings (e.g. sausage casings)
 09.3	Semi-preserved fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms
 09.4	Fully preserved, including canned or fermented fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms
 10.2.3	Dried and/or heat coagulated egg products
 10.3	Preserved eggs, including alkaline, salted, and canned eggs
 10.4	Egg-based desserts (e.g. custard)
 11.6	Table-top sweeteners, including those containing high-intensity sweeteners
 12.2.2	Seasonings and condiments
 12.3	Vinegars
12.4	Mustards
12.5	Soups and broths
12.6	Sauces and like products
12.7	Salads (e.g. macaroni salad, potato salad) and sandwich spreads excluding cocoa- and nut-based spreads of food categories 04.2.2.5 and 05.1.3
12.8	Yeast and like products
12.9	Soybean-based seasonings and condiments
12.10	Protein products other than from soybeans
13.3	Dietetic foods intended for special medical purposes (excluding products of food category 13.1)
13.4	Dietetic formulae for slimming purposes and weight reduction
13.5	Dietetic foods (e.g. supplementary foods for dietary use) excluding products of food categories 13.1 - 13.4 and 13.6
13.6	Food supplements
14.1.4	Water-based flavoured drinks, including "sport," "energy," or "electrolyte" drinks and particulated drinks
14.2.1	Beer and malt beverages
14.2.2	Cider and perry
14.2.4	Wines (other than grape)
14.2.5	Mead
14.2.6	Distilled spirituous beverages containing more than 15% alcohol
14.2.7	Aromatized alcoholic beverages (e.g. beer, wine and spirituous cooler-type beverages, low alcoholic refreshers)
15.0	Ready-to-eat savouries
16.0	Prepared foods

Note: Unless otherwise specified, food additive provisions apply to the food category indicated (e.g. Dairy), as well as to all subcategories of that category (e.g. Cheese, Ripened Cheese, etc.).

